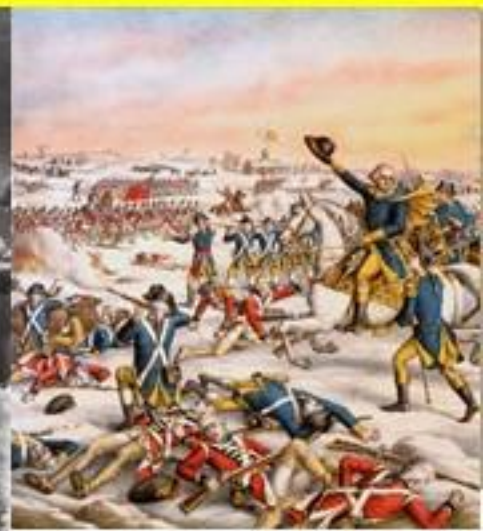


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 25

UNIFICATION OF GERMANY - 2

- 1** Like Italy, the unification of Germany did not take place by popular revolts and mass agitations. In both these countries the subaltern pressure of liberal from the below tried to assert in the revolutionary year of 1848, but the impact was very limited.
- 2** Both the countries were unified from above by bureaucratic process, diplomacy and manipulating the foreign relations. While Cavour was the chief architect in Italian unification, Otto von Bismarck proved to be his counterpart in case of German unification.
- 3** In 1857 Fredrick William IV became insane and after his death William I became the ruler of Prussia. He was an autocrat and wanted Prussia should be strong and powerful.
- 4** In 1862 William I appointed Bismarck as minister-president of Prussia. Bismarck had no faith in parliamentary institutions and was fully an autocrat.



- 5 He was convinced that solution to the problems which Germany faced did not lie in the resolution and majority of votes but iron, blood and use of force.
- 6 William I was convinced that in order to attain German unification, Prussia should have a strong army.
- 7 William I envisaged unification of Germany but under the dominance of Prussia was a very much against the interests of the Austria.
- 8 The only possible solution in such situation was to expel Austria from Germany through military action.
- 9 For this William I wanted to reorganise and strengthen the army and to mobilize the expenditure that was to be incurred in reorganization of army through increased taxation.



- 10 However, the Prussian legislature which was dominated by the liberals was determined to have constitutional reforms before the reorganization of the army.
- 11 The king and the legislature took the extremely opposite stances on the issue of military reorganisation, thus a constitutional deadlock aroused in Prussia. Bismarck was appointed as minister-president of Prussia during this decisive time in 1862.
- 12 Bismarck agreed with the view point of the king William I that need of the hour was reorganization of Prussian army if Germany was to be unified.
- 13 Bismarck being a seasoned reactionary was of the view that 'the great questions of the day will not be settled by means of speeches and majority decisions but the iron and blood'.
- 14 In order to accomplish these task and designs he side-lined the liberals and did not care for the legislature for raising money or for the reorganisation of the army.



CAVOUR VS BISMARCK

CAVOUR	BISMARCK
Cavour was liberal and had full faith in limited monarchy and parliamentary government.	Bismarck, on the other hand, was an autocrat and reactionary. he had a strong dislike for the parliamentary politics, votes and liberal tendencies.
He had utmost respect for the will of people and worked by the means of parliaments and plebiscites.	He firmly believed that Germany can only be unified under the aegis of Prussia thorough strong military along with acting upon the policy of blood and iron.



CAVOUR



BISMARCK



FOREIGN POLICY OF BISMARCK

- 1** In unification of Italy, the diplomacy and foreign policy of Cavour played a pivotal role.
- 2** Unlike Sardinia-piedmont which essentially required the assistance of foreign nations for the unification of Italy, the case of German unification was different.
- 3** Prussia at that time was strong state and thus had not to look at the foreign states for the unification of Germany.
- 4** The neutrality of the foreign powers was enough for Prussia to ensure the unification of Germany.



FOREIGN POLICY OF BISMARCK

5 Thus Bismarck wanted that in case of the conflict between Prussia and Austria or another country the rest other European powers should remain neutral and must not ally with the hostile state.

6 To diplomatically isolate Austria Bismarck made the following arrangements with the other European countries.

7 He concluded a commercial treaty with France, giving her the favourable terms. In 1863, he helped czar of Russia to suppress the polish revolt and thus gained his support for the future.



After reorganisation of the army, Bismarck used the army and the diplomacy with great effect in three wars which proved extremely significant for the unification of Germany.

1 WAR WITH DENMARK (1864): SCHLESWIG-HOLSTEIN QUESTION

- 1 Schleswig-Holstein were two duchies located on the border of Prussia and Denmark, which were under the control of Denmark.
- 2 The population of Schleswig was Danish in its northern portion, German in the south, and mixed in the northern towns and centre.
- 3 The population of Holstein was almost entirely German.



1 WAR WITH DENMARK (1864): SCHLESWIG-HOLSTEIN QUESTION

4 The king of Denmark was eager to annex both these duchies to his kingdom. Since the duchies had German population therefore, these were opposed to any such move and wanted to be part of German confederation.

5 Prussia and Austria were both against the intentions of Denmark to annex the duchies.

6 In 1863 a new ruler came to the throne of Denmark and made endeavours to annex both these duchies to his kingdom.



1 WAR WITH DENMARK (1864): SCHLESWIG-HOLSTEIN QUESTION

- 7 This caused Prussia and Austria to declare war in 1864 against Denmark. Denmark was defeated in the two decisive battles.
- 8 After the war it was agreed between the victors that Austria will administer Holstein while Schleswig will be administered by Prussia.
- 9 But soon the administrative rights over Schleswig- Holstein became the bone of contention between the victors which finally culminated into Austro-Prussian war.



2 AUSTRO-PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDOWA (1866)

- 1** Prussia and Austria, the arch rivals entered into an alliance in war against Denmark (1864) to get the lion's share from the two duchies.
- 2** After the defeat of Denmark, Bismarck was very keen that advantage should be taken of the situation to strengthen the position of Prussia.
- 3** Bismarck by the use of diplomacy gave Holstein to Austria. Holstein was surrounded by Prussian territories.
- 4** This made Austria apprehensive about its control in the future therefore she demanded the unification of two duchies under her domination.
- 5** Bismarck needed to get rid of Austrian influence in order to make a unified Germany for this Prussia sends its army into Austrian held Holstein which proved to be immediate cause of war.
- 6** As mentioned earlier, Prussia was strong enough to tackle the Austrian danger alone. However, any foreign help to Austria could have proved fatal to Prussia.



2 AUSTRO-PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDOWA (1866)

- 7 Thus Bismarck diplomatically ensured that Austria should have no friends. Bismarck ensured the neutrality of the other powers in the following manner.

FRANCE

- Bismarck claimed that he has no aggressive intentions towards France.
- He gave France a dubious promise about getting some territory

ITALY

- Italy was promised Venetia, if she remained neutral or sided with Prussia in the war.

RUSSIA

- In 1863 Bismarck helped czar of Russia to suppress the Polish revolt and thus gained his support for future.



2 AUSTRO-PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDOWA (1866)

- 8 Austria was decisively defeated in the battle of Sedowa (1866).
- 9 The German confederation was dissolved after the war and the whole northern Germany got unified under the domination of Prussia.
- 10 Prussia gained the control Schleswig and Holstein as well.



IMPORTANCE OF BATTLE OF SEDOWA

- 1 Battle of Sedowa finally eliminated Austria, the biggest stumbling block for Prussia to unify Germany under her domination.
- 2 Thus battle proved to be watershed in the unification of Germany by establishing a north German confederation.
- 3 The battle also proved to be stepping stone in the unification of Italy as after the defeat of Austria the state of Venetia got unified with Italy.
- 4 The Battle of Sedowa was also a diplomatic defeat for France. France got no compensation (as promised by Bismarck) for remaining neutral.
- 5 Prussia now turned out to be stronger than France, and thus the balance of power shifted in Europe in the favour of Prussia.
- 6 Bismarck treated Austria very generously after the defeat. This was done in order to ensure her support in future for unification.



3 FRANCE- PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDAN (1870-71)

1 After the Battle of Sedowa the north German states got unified under the domination of Prussia. Nonetheless the southern states were yet to be unified. The following were the two biggest impediments in the unification of the southern states.

- Many of the southern states were jealous with the growing domination of Prussia.
- France was alarmed by the growing power of Prussia and gradual shift of balance of power in Europe. More over the people of France had a feeling that the defeat of Austria in Austro-Prussian war was that of France and not that of Austria.

2 Bismarck in such critical circumstances wanted a national war with France i.e., a war in which the people of northern and southern states of Germany get aligned together against France.

3 He got this opportunity when Spanish throne got vacant and Prussia supported the candidature of Leopold, a distant relative of Prussian king.



3 FRANCE- PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDAN (1870-71)

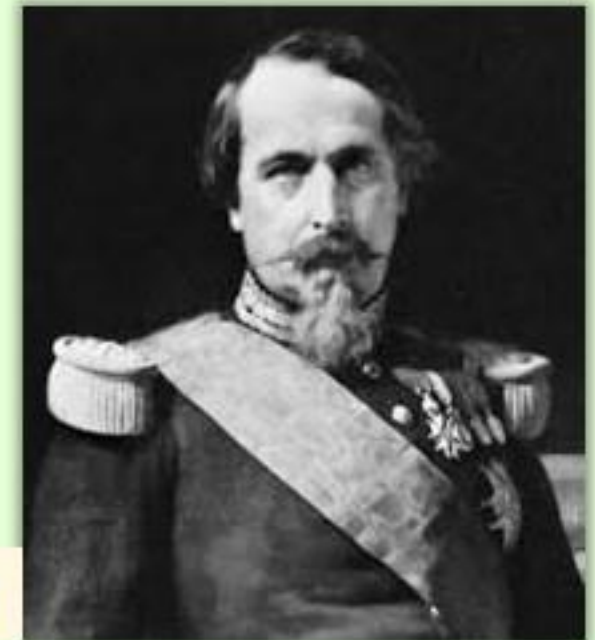
4 This was not acceptable to French king napoleon III who sent his ambassador to the king of Prussia demanding an assurance that the candidature of family member of the king should not be supported by Prussia.

5 Bismarck manipulated one of the telegrams of the king in such a way that her ambassador had been insulted whereas Prussians felt that their king had been disgraced.

6 Resentment in France was so great that napoleon was forced to declare a war on Prussia. The war was declared.



LEOPOLD

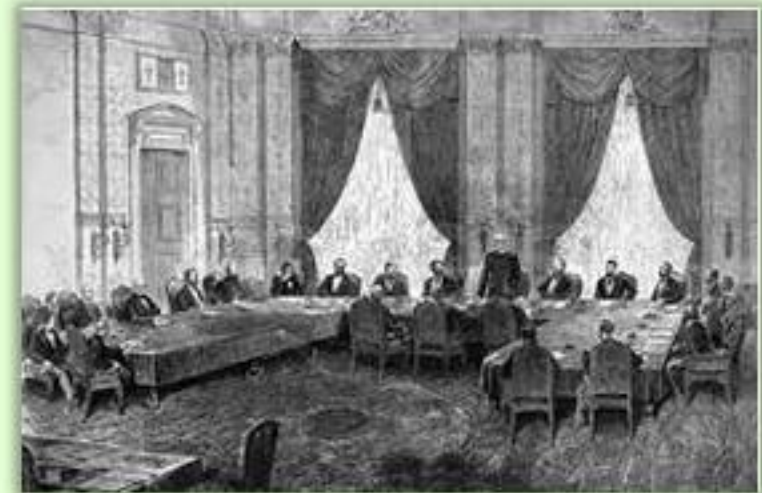


NAPOLEON III

3 FRANCE- PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDAN (1870-71)

7 Bismarck diplomatically isolated France in the following ways:

- Austria was generously treated after the Battle of Sadowa (1866), the purpose was to gain her support in the near future for the unification.
- Italy was given Venetia for remaining neutral after the Austro-Prussian war. Also papal states in Italy were yet to be unified and France was the main obstacle in the unification. Thus the neutrality of Italy was ensured.
- Russia was defeated by France in Crimean war in 1855. Russia wanted to avenge that defeat; therefore an alliance between Russia and France was next to impossible.



3 FRANCE- PRUSSIAN WAR: BATTLE OF SEDAN (1870-71)

8 French armies were defeated on the battle of sedan. The war came to an end with the treaty of Frankfurt (1871) the main provisions of the treaty were:

- King of Prussia was accepted as the ruler of Germany and southern state of Germany was to be part of German confederation.
- France agreed to give Alsace and Lorraine to Germany.
- France agreed to pay to Prussia heavy war indemnity.

9 In this way task of unification of Germany was completed with the efforts of Bismarck.



- 1** The battle of sedan also proved significant for the unification of Italy and France.
- 2** During the war French army withdrew from Rome, which was occupied by Italian forces.
- 3** This unified papal states with Italy and completed the final stage of Italian unification as well. Also after the defeat of Napoleon III, a republic was created in France.
- 4** Battle of sedan reinforced the fact that balance of power had shifted in Europe in the favour of Germany.
- 5** France no longer remained to be the most powerful country. The glory of France of Napoleonic era passed into oblivion after this battle.



QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Unification of Germany took place through the "policy of Blood and Iron". Comment.
250 words
2. Assess the relative importance of the Zollverein and Bismarck's policies in bringing about the unification of Germany. 250 words
250 words
1. Why had Prussia replaced Austria as the leading Germanic power by 1866?
150 words

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588